



Flying Without Wings

Limnorr lets you write the programs you always wanted to... without the hassle of coding!

Nimish Chandiramani

Limnorr—a new “visual programming tool”, lets you create programs without having to write any code, and unlike Scratch (<http://scratch.mit.edu>), it's not for kids' games and animation, either.

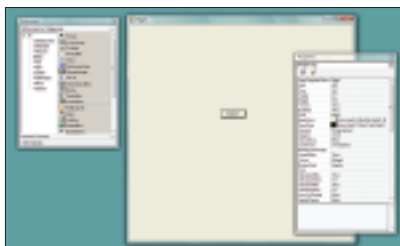
The key here is *event-based programming*—basically, your application is in an idle state till something (like a mouse click or the press of a key) happens. Here, we'll create a simple program that opens a dialog that says “Hello” (or anything you prefer, for that matter).

The Very Basics

On start up, Limnorr asks you to create a new application and decide whether it'll be a Desktop Application or a Kiosk Application (one that fills the screen and is the only application to run at any time). Later, you can also change the nature of the program from within Limnorr.

The main toolbar is on the left, and to access the main menu, you must click on the Menu button. To minimise Limnorr, click on the button at the very top. The rest of the screen is taken up by an empty window for you to build on—a ‘page’ in Limnorr-speak.

We'll be following the event-action approach here. We'll first create an action, and then find an event to associate it with. For example, let's create an Exit button for our application. Right-click on Page 1 and choose Make

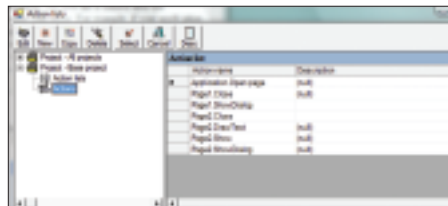


Start by creating a button

Action > Close. Let the name of the action remain the default. Now to create a button.

Items like buttons, text boxes and so on are called ‘performers’ in Limnorr. Click on the Performers button on the toolbar. Under Performers by Categories > Basic, you'll find Button. Drag a button on to your page and position it where required.

To change the text on the button, right-click on it and choose Properties. Once you're done having your fun here, it's time to attach the Close action to the button's Click event. Right-

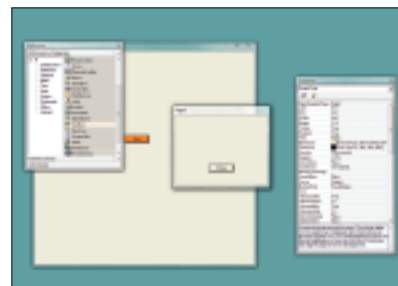


Add an action to your button

click on the button and choose Assign Actions > Click. Select the row with Page1.Close and hit the Select button. Click on Run at the bottom of the toolbar. When you click the button, your application should close and you should return to Limnorr.

Another Page

Right-click anywhere and choose Add / Open Page > Add New Page Template. Page 2 will now be created, and you can manipulate this any way you please. Here, too, create an action called Page2.Close, and associate that with a Close button like before. To give this page a more dialog-like look, right-click on the page and choose Properties. In the Properties dialog, change Control Box to False and BorderStyle to FixedDialog.



Page 2, after some work

For the text, right-click on Page 2 and choose Make Action > DrawText. An Action Data dialog will come up, where you can enter the text you want to draw (under Text around the bottom left). To make sure this text is drawn when Page 2 appears, right-click on the page and choose Assign Actions > AfterShow. Choose Page2.DrawText in the Actions dialog and hit the Select button—just like before.

To have Page 2 as a dialog box, we need to create the ShowDialog action—right-click on Page 2 and choose Make Action > ShowDialog. We want Page 2 to show up when a button on Page 1 is clicked, so now go back to Page 1. Change the text of the button you had created, to “Press Me!” (or something as tempting). Right-click on it and choose Assign Actions > Click. In the Actions dialog, choose Page2.ShowDialog and hit the Select button.

On running the program, you'll see that Page 2 opens when you click on the button in Page 1. Also, you can't do anything in Page 1 without closing Page 2.

With something as easy as this at your disposal, just go ahead and start programming. Send us your programs, and if they're good, we'll feature them on the DVD! ■

nimish.chandiramani@thinkdigit.com